

Guide: Getting Microsoft Office on a Linux Computer

In case your Linux computer is already installed with an Office suite, such as Office 365, 2021, 2019 or 2016, continue using your Office suite and skip this guide. Otherwise, use this guide to install or access a version of the Microsoft Office suite that your computer supports, free of cost, for academic purposes.

DO NOT use the online Office 365 version at any point during the semester! Rather, install an Office version to your computer based on this guide.

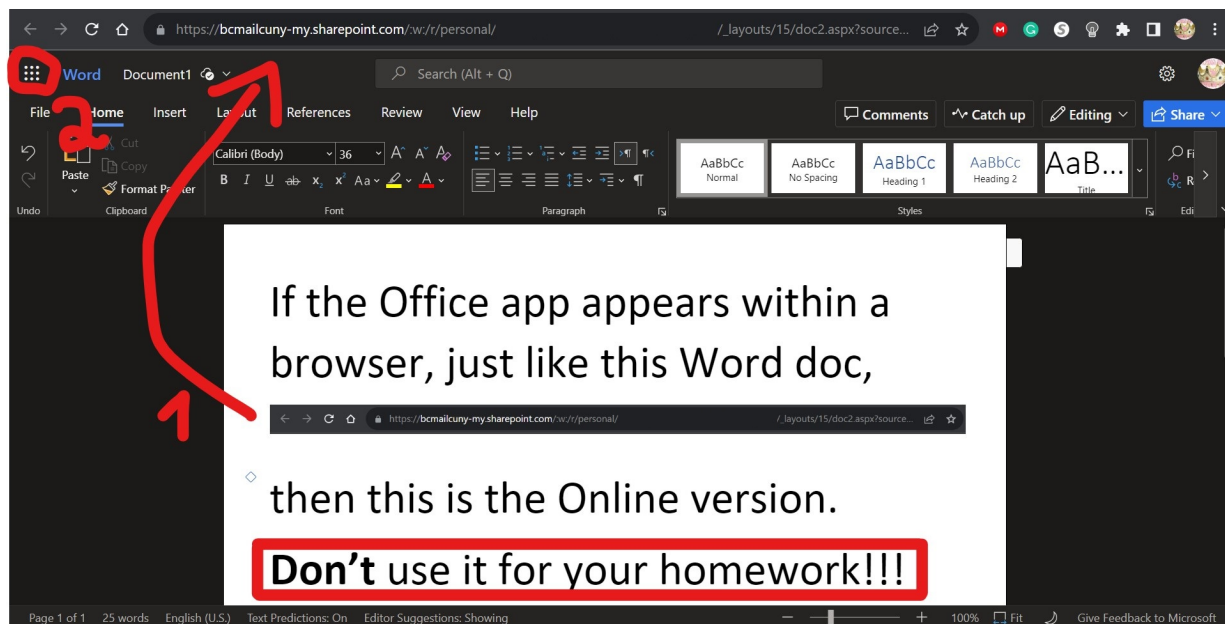


Figure 1: A Word document open within Online Office 365 version. The text in the Word document says, "If the Office app appears within a browser, just like this Word doc, then this is the Online version. Don't use it for your homework!"

! Points will be taken off an assignment if parts are missing because the online Office 365 suite was used !



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Need Any Help?

If you struggle installing Microsoft Office at any step, or if an Office app takes long time to open/work, please contact the Brooklyn College IT Help Desk office by either:

- Email: helpdesk@brooklyn.cuny.edu
- Phone: (718) 951-4357. Operational hours are: Monday–Thursday, 8 a.m.–8 p.m.; Friday 9 a.m.–5 p.m.

Installation instructions are on the next pages.

Installation Steps on Linux Computers

This guide will show you how to access Microsoft Office 2016 on your Linux computer through a Windows 10 virtual desktop:

1. Find your Linux computer's distribution and version number. The distribution is one of: SUSE, Debian, Ubuntu, CentOS, and RHEL, while the release number has a format like 8 or 16.04. See how to find this information here: <https://www.cyberciti.biz/faq/how-to-check-os-version-in-linux-command-line/>
2. In the table below, click on the link corresponding to the distribution and version number of your computer:

32-bit Systems	64-bit Systems
Ubuntu 16.04	Ubuntu 16.04
	Ubuntu 18.04
	Ubuntu 20.04
	Ubuntu 22.04
Red Hat (RHEL) 6.10	Red Hat (RHEL) 6.10
	Red Hat (RHEL) 7.6
	Red Hat (RHEL) 7.7
	Red Hat (RHEL) 7.8
	Red Hat (RHEL) 7.9
	Red Hat (RHEL) 8.0
	Red Hat (RHEL) 8.1
	Red Hat (RHEL) 8.2
	Red Hat (RHEL) 8.3
	Red Hat (RHEL) 8.4
	Red Hat (RHEL) 8.5
	Red Hat (RHEL) 8.6
	Red Hat (RHEL) 8.7
	Red Hat (RHEL) 8.8
	Red Hat (RHEL) 9.0
	Red Hat (RHEL) 9.1
	Red Hat (RHEL) 9.2

3. Click on the 'DOWNLOAD NOW' button at the bottom-right of the screen:
4. Click on the **Download Now** button at the right-hand side of the screen.
5. Depending on the browser you use, click on the **Run** button (in Edge or Internet Explorer), on the "VMware-Horizon" file itself (in Chrome), or **Save File** (in Firefox).

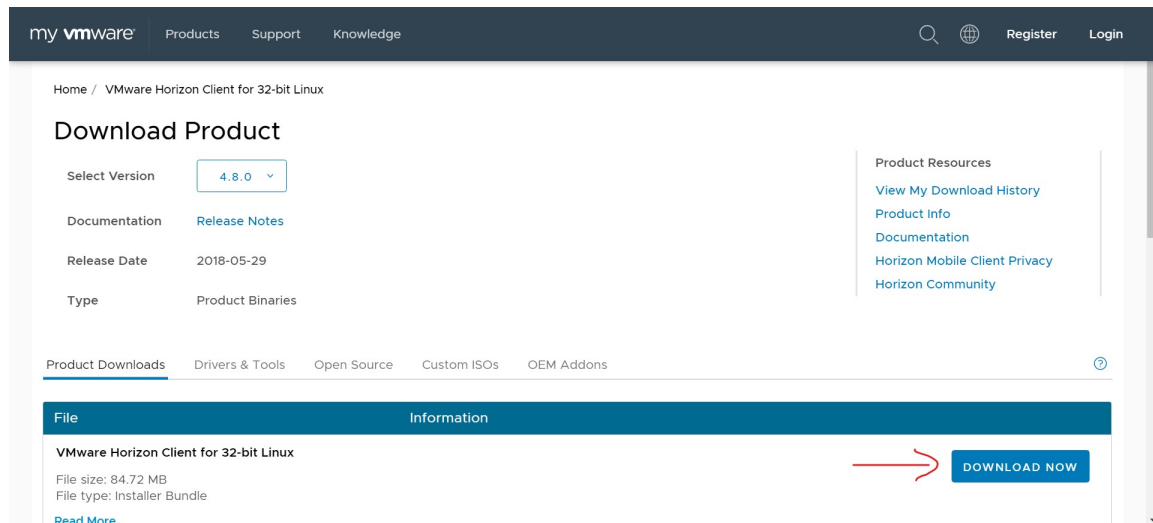


Figure 2: The ‘DOWNLOAD NOW’ button at the bottom-right of the screen. Note that the software version on the image might differ from the version that you will be downloading. (by [Miriam Briskman](#), licensed under [CC BY-ND 4.0](#))

6. A file called “VMware-Horizon-Client...” will start downloading to your computer. Wait until it finishes downloading.
7. Go to the **Downloads** folder on your computer.
8. Right-click on the file that downloaded, choose **Move to**, and select a folder where you can easily access the file on your computer, such as on your desktop.
9. Open the terminal, and change the directory to the place where you saved the file. In the desktop example, enter: `cd ~/Desktop`
This will let the terminal move its operation into your desktop.
10. Then, enter: `chmod a+x VMware-Horizon-Client`
and, before pressing Return, press on the Tab key on the keyboard to auto-complete the long name of the file.
11. Enter: `sudo ./VMware-Horizon-Client`
and, before pressing Return, press on the Tab key on the keyboard to auto-complete the long name of the file.
12. Enter your computer administrator’s password.
13. The VMware Horizon Client installer window will open. Click on:
I accept the terms in the license agreement.
and then click **Next**.

14. Click **Next** again, and then click on **Install**.
15. Wait until the installation process finishes. You will know it finished when you see the message:
Installation was successful.
on the window.
16. Check the box next to:
Register and start installed service(s) after the installation
and click on **Scan**.
17. Wait until the scan finishes, and then click on **Close**.
18. Using the search bar of your computer, search for “VMware”, and click once on **VMware Horizon Client** that shows up in the results of the search.
19. When the VMware program window opens, click on **New Server** and enter:
`virtualdesktop.cuny.edu`
into the line. Click **Connect**.
20. If an error message appears, click on **Accept**.
21. A login window will appear: use your CUNYFirst credentials to sign in. In the **User name** line, enter your
`first.lastXX@login.cuny.edu`
username. Replace **first** and **last** by your first and last names, and **XX** by the last 2 digits of your EMPLID. In the **Password** line, enter the password that you use to log into CUNYFirst.
22. Click on the **Login** button.
23. Double-click on **Windows 10 All Software** or on any one of the other desktops.
24. Wait a few minutes until the desktop finishes opening.
25. After the desktop opens, click on Window’s **Start** button in the bottom-left corner of the screen.
26. You will see a scroll-able list of all the applications installed on the desktop, including the Office applications that we use in our course: Access, Excel, PowerPoint and Word.
27. To use an application, just click on its logo. For example, click on “Access 2016” to open Access. Otherwise, type “Access 2016” using your keyboard and click on the red-colored logo of Access 2016 that appears in the results of the search.

28. When you finish your work and save the files (please read the note below,) you can exit the desktop by pressing on the **X** in the right corner of the gray strip on the top of the machine.
29. To access the desktop and Office 2016 again at any time in the future, complete steps 18 to 28, inclusively. Enjoy!

Congrats! Your Office 2016 applications are ready to use!

Important: Save your files!

Remember to frequently save your data to your local device, USB storage device, or OneDrive. Be sure to save your data before exiting the CUNY Virtual Desktop or your work will be lost! No user data is retained in the CUNY Virtual Desktop. Any unsaved data in the environment will be lost after 20 minutes of inactivity or disconnect time. Use of the CUNY Virtual desktop is limited to 8 hours per session and is for academic purposes only.

For an example of saving a work to a USB drive (on Mac computers), see https://www.cuny.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/4/page-assets/about/administration/offices/cis/virtual-desktop/usage-instructions/4_VMware_Mac_USBSave-1.pdf.

For frequently asked questions and answers about VMWare, see <https://www.cuny.edu/about/administration/offices/cis/virtual-desktop/faqs/>.

Note: The instructions above are based on <https://www.cuny.edu/about/administration/offices/cis/virtual-desktop/>.